

The Spirit of Your *Father*

Do not fear; you are more valuable than many sparrows.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 10:16-33 in the LSB | 26:21 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: Matthew 10:16-33 – The Holy Spirit Will Speak Through the Disciples?. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 10:16-33, the middle of Jesus' mission discourse. He sends the Twelve as sheep among wolves, warns of courts, floggings, governors and kings, tells them not to worry about what to say, and repeats 'do not fear,' ending with a promise and a warning: whoever confesses Him He will confess before His Father.
- From verse 17 on, Jesus seems to look past this first trip (only to Israel, 10:5) to a later time of persecution, when they stand before governors and Gentiles, as in Acts. Some scholars think Matthew gathered sayings by theme; either way, Jesus is preparing them for when He is not physically with them.
- Who are the wolves? Jesus called the crowds sheep without a shepherd (9:36), echoing Ezekiel 34's bad shepherds, and warned of false prophets who are 'inwardly are ravenous wolves' (7:15). Zephaniah 3 calls Jerusalem's judges 'wolves at evening.' The wolves are the leaders who should have known the Tanakh and recognized their Messiah.
- 'The Spirit of your Father who speaks in you' (10:20): hear it as a Jew would. The ruach of God hovers at creation, and Ezekiel 36-37 promise God's Spirit within His people to cause them to walk in His statutes, and to breathe life into dry bones. The Spirit led Jesus into the wilderness, where He answered every test with 'It is written.'

> *"It's the persecutors who should dread God.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"To acknowledge him is to declare allegiance to him, is to declare solidarity with Jesus.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- So the Spirit is not a 'good possession' that turns disciples into megaphones. He brings to mind God's word. That is what Acts shows: Peter at Pentecost, Stephen's speech, Paul and Silas speaking 'the word of the Lord' to the jailer.
- The lesson for the disciples, then and now: when the disciples of Jesus know God's word, they'll never fear to know what to say. The answer to anxiety about being caught unprepared is to know God's word even more.



Stephen before his accusers

Rembrandt, The Stoning of Saint Stephen, 1625. Musée des Beaux-Arts de Lyon via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Find the lesson for the original audience

The teacher talks through his method out loud: (1) Who is the original audience? The disciples. (2) Why is Jesus speaking to them this way? (3) What did they need to know that they did not? Verse 19 says 'do not worry,' so they would face anxiety. Put the pieces together (anxiety, the Spirit, God's word) and a lesson appears. It is a muscle that grows with practice.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 10:16-33 and goes back to Ezekiel, Zephaniah, Matthew 4, John and Acts. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 10:16-33

Ezekiel 34:8-10

God against the shepherds who fed themselves.

Read in full: sheep among wolves, the Spirit of your Father, and 'do not fear.'

Matthew 7:15
False prophets in sheep's clothing, inwardly ravenous wolves.

Zephaniah 3:3-4
Jerusalem's judges are wolves at evening.

John 16:2-3
Whoever kills you will think he is offering service to God.

Ezekiel 36:25-27
A new heart, and My Spirit within you to walk in My statutes.

Ezekiel 37:1-14
Breath into the dry bones.

Ezekiel 37:24
My servant David, one shepherd; they will walk in My judgments.

Matthew 4:1-4
Led by the Spirit; 'It is written.'

Acts 16:25-34
Paul and Silas speak the word of the Lord to the jailer.

John 14:26
The Holy Spirit will bring to your remembrance all that I said.

Matthew 10:34-42
Coming next: not peace, but a sword.

Key verses in the LSB

> "For it is not you who speak, but the Spirit of your Father who speaks in you."
> Matthew 10:20 (LSB)

> "I will put My Spirit within you and cause you to walk in My statutes, and you will be careful to do My judgments."
> Ezekiel 36:27 (LSB)

> "So do not fear; you are more valuable than many sparrows."
> Matthew 10:31 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Sheep in the midst of wolves

Who the wolves are, courts and synagogues, and a hard verse.

SHEEP AMONG WOLVES · MATTHEW 10:16

Shrewd as serpents, innocent as doves

MATTHEW 10:16 (LSB)

WISE

“Behold, I send you out as sheep in the midst of wolves; so be shrewd as serpents and innocent as doves.”

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus tells them to be both wise and innocent with those who will respond with hostility, then warns of physical harm and repeats: do not fear. Their experience will mirror His.

FROM THE VIDEO This is not the first mention of sheep: the crowds were 'like sheep without a shepherd' (9:36), a callback to Ezekiel 34. Matthew 9:36

◆ Factbook: Serpent ◆ Factbook: Dove

WHO ARE THE WOLVES?

Shepherds who fed themselves

EZEKIEL · EZEKIEL 34:10

“Thus says Lord Yahweh, “Behold, I am against the shepherds, and I will seek My flock from their hand and make them cease from shepherding the flock.”

ZEPHANIAH · ZEPHANIAH 3:3

“Her princes in her midst are roaring lions; / Her judges are wolves at evening; / They leave nothing to gnaw for the morning.”

FROM THE VIDEO In Jesus' day it got worse: the shepherds pretended to be sheep but were wolves inside. 'Beware of the false prophets, who come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly are ravenous wolves' (7:15). Matthew 7:15

FROM THE VIDEO The wolves are the leaders, officials and priests: those who should have known the Tanakh and recognized their Messiah, yet persecuted God's messengers in the name of righteousness. John 16:2-3

◆ Factbook: Wolf ◆ Factbook: Zephaniah (the prophet) ◆ Factbook: Ezekiel (prophet)

COURTS AND SYNAGOGUES · MATTHEW 10:17-18

Before governors and kings

MATTHEW 10:17-18 (LSB)

WITNESS

“But beware of men, for they will deliver you over to the courts and flog you in their synagogues; and you will even be brought before governors and kings for My sake, as a testimony to them and to the Gentiles.”

FROM THE VIDEO In 10:5 He said 'Do not go in the way of the Gentiles'; now they will testify to Gentiles. Jesus is looking beyond this first mission to the persecution of Acts, when the people's favor had faded.

FROM THE VIDEO Synagogue flogging was a judicial penalty for members, so Jesus pictures His followers still inside the synagogues, as in Acts. Acts 22:19

BACKGROUND Paul: 'Five times I received from the Jews forty lashes less one' (2 Corinthians 11:24). The apostles were beaten by the Sanhedrin and left 'rejoicing' (Acts 5:40-41). 2 Corinthians 11:24 Acts 5:40-41

◆ Factbook: Synagogue ◆ Factbook: Persecution ◆ Factbook: Gentiles



VERSE 23

Until the Son of Man comes

⏳ MATTHEW 10:23 (LSB) PUZZLE

““But whenever they persecute you in this city, flee to the next; for truly I say to you, you will not finish going through the cities of Israel until the Son of Man comes.”

FROM THE VIDEO This verse has perplexed Christians for a long time. The teacher suspects it is Jesus coming in judgment on Israel and its temple in AD 70: the explanation with the fewest problems, he says, though he leaves the topic for another time.

BACKGROUND Other readings: the resurrection, Pentecost, or His final return, with the mission to Israel still unfinished until then. See Debates below.

◆ Factbook: Son of Man ◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

> *“It's the persecutors who should dread God.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

The Spirit of your Father

Hearing 10:20 through Ezekiel 36-37, Matthew 4 and Acts.



MATTHEW 10:19-20

Do not worry about what to say

🕊️ MATTHEW 10:19-20 (LSB) SPIRIT

“But when they deliver you over, do not worry about how or what you are to say; for it will be given to you in that hour what you are to say. For it is not you who speak, but the Spirit of your Father who speaks in you.”

FROM THE VIDEO Hear it as a Jew who grew up in the Tanakh would. The Spirit (ruach) is there at creation, 'hovering over the surface of the waters' (Genesis 1:2), and at the moments God saves His people. Genesis 1:2

FROM THE VIDEO Matthew does not mention the Holy Spirit often; when he does, it is often tied to the spread of God's kingdom. Matthew 12:28 Matthew 28:19

◆ Factbook: Holy Spirit



EZEKIEL 36:25-27

My Spirit within you

❤️ EZEKIEL 36:26-27 (LSB) NEW HEART

“Moreover, I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; and I will remove the heart of stone from your flesh and give you a heart of flesh. I will put My Spirit within you and cause you to walk in My statutes, and you will be careful to do My judgments.”

FROM THE VIDEO God promises to gather His people, sprinkle clean water on them, and put His Spirit within them. Notice what the Spirit does: He causes them to walk in God's statutes and obey Him.

BACKGROUND Peter at Pentecost: 'I will pour out My Spirit on all mankind' (Acts 2:17, from Joel 2:28). Acts 2:16-17

◆ Factbook: Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Joel (the prophet)



EZEKIEL 37

Breath into dry bones

EZEKIEL 37:24 (LSB) LIFE

““And My servant David will be king over them, and they will all have one shepherd; and they will walk in My judgments and keep My statutes and do them.”

FROM THE VIDEO The next chapter: a valley of dry bones, and the prophet calls the breath to come and give them life. The promises end with one shepherd, David's heir, and the same phrase: they will walk in My judgments. Ezekiel 37:9-10

BACKGROUND The Hebrew ruach is 'breath,' 'wind' and 'Spirit' in the same chapter (37:9, 14). Ezekiel 37:14

◆ Factbook: David



MATTHEW 4:1-4 AND ACTS

It is written

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 4:1

“Then Jesus was led up by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil.”

JESUS · MATTHEW 4:4

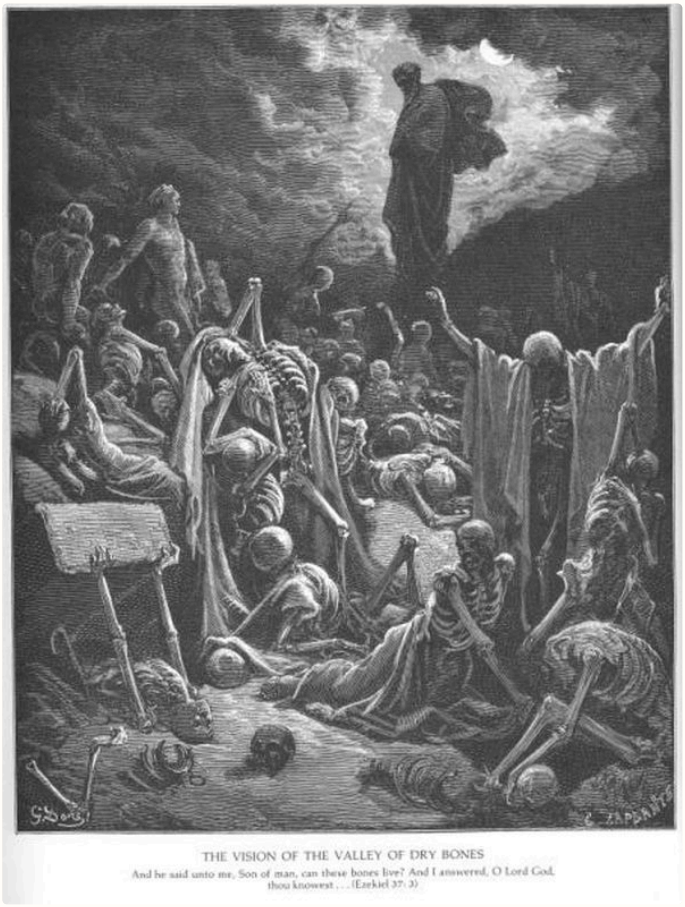
“But He answered and said, “It is written, ‘Man shall not live on bread alone, but on every word that proceeds out of the mouth of God.’””

FROM THE VIDEO The Spirit led Jesus into the wilderness, and every time He answered the devil with Scripture. The video connects it to Ezekiel 36-37: the Spirit causes God's people to walk by His word.

FROM THE VIDEO So 10:20 is no magic trick or 'good possession' that turns people into megaphones for novel sayings. In trouble, the Spirit guides disciples to speak the word of God, which they know from the Tanakh and from Jesus' teaching.

FROM THE VIDEO That is what Acts shows: Peter's Pentecost sermon, Stephen recounting Israel's story, and Paul and Silas: 'they spoke the word of the Lord to him together with all who were in his household' (Acts 16:32). Acts 2:14-36 Acts 7:2-53 Acts 16:30-32

◆ Factbook: Temptation of Jesus ◆ Factbook: Holy Spirit



Breath into the dry bones

Gustave Doré, Ezekiel's Vision of the Valley of Dry Bones, before 1883. Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *Jesus is saying that in the moment of trouble, the Holy Spirit will guide the disciples to speak the word of God.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Do not fear

Housetops, sparrows, and confessing Jesus.

MATTHEW 10:24-27

Proclaim it on the housetops

MATTHEW 10:25-27 (LSB)

SPEAK UP

"It is enough for the disciple that he become like his teacher, and the slave like his master. If they have called the head of the house Beelzebul, how much more the members of his household! "Therefore do not fear them, for there is nothing concealed that will not be revealed, and hidden that will not be

known. What I tell you in the darkness, speak in the light; and what you hear whispered in your ear, proclaim upon the housetops.”

FROM THE VIDEO 'Whispered in your ear... proclaim upon the housetops' is an idiom: what Jesus tells them privately now, they must speak publicly later.

BACKGROUND The Pharisees had already said He cast out demons by 'the ruler of the demons' (9:34); in 12:24 they name Beelzebul. The captions spell it 'be ela bull.' Matthew 9:34 Matthew 12:24

◆ Factbook: Pharisees ◆ Factbook: Satan



MATTHEW 10:28-31

More valuable than many sparrows

🐦 MATTHEW 10:29-31 (LSB)

FEAR NOT

“Are not two sparrows sold for an assarion? And yet not one of them will fall to the ground apart from your Father. But the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not fear; you are more valuable than many sparrows.”

FROM THE VIDEO 'Fear' comes three times in verses 28-31. Jesus is not trying to make His people afraid of the Father; then 'do not fear' (10:31) would make no sense. He assures them that those who kill the body are not as powerful as the One who can destroy soul and body in hell.

FROM THE VIDEO So it is not the apostles, doing the Father's will, who should dread God this way. It's the persecutors.

BACKGROUND An assarion was a small Roman copper coin. Luke has five sparrows for two (Luke 12:6-7). Luke 12:6-7

◆ Factbook: Gehenna



MATTHEW 10:32-33

Confess Me before men

🤝 MATTHEW 10:32-33 (LSB)

ALLEGIANCE

““Therefore everyone who confesses Me before men, I will also confess him before My Father who is in heaven. But whoever denies Me before men, I will also deny him before My Father who is in heaven.”

FROM THE VIDEO To confess (acknowledge) Jesus is to declare allegiance and solidarity with Him, even in persecution and suffering. Jesus will declare the same of us before His Father; deny Him, and He will do the same.

FROM THE VIDEO The teacher says this promise, more than the warning about hell, is the one that should give us pause.

BACKGROUND Peter later denies Him three times (26:69-75), and is restored (John 21:15-19). Matthew 26:69-75 John 21:15-19

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter)

> *“To acknowledge him is to declare allegiance to him, is to declare solidarity with Jesus.*

From the video

06

Who's who in 10:16-33

What the video says, then a short background note.

Jesus

VIDEO Prepares the Twelve for persecution, promises the Spirit's help, and calls them not to fear.

BACKGROUND Mark 13:9-13 and Luke 21:12-19 place similar words in His last week.

Mark 13:9-13 | Luke 21:12-19 | ◆ Jesus Christ

The Twelve

VIDEO Sheep sent among wolves; anxious, and told not to be.

BACKGROUND In Acts they are flogged, jailed and brought before rulers (Acts 4-5).

Acts 5:40-41 | ◆ The Twelve | ◆ Persecution

The wolves

VIDEO The leaders, officials and priests who should have known the Tanakh.

BACKGROUND Jesus says they will flog His messengers in their synagogues (23:34).

Matthew 23:34 | ◆ Wolf | ◆ Scribe | ◆ Pharisees

Governors and kings

VIDEO Where the disciples will testify before Gentiles.

BACKGROUND Paul stood before Felix, Festus and King Agrippa at Caesarea (Acts 24-26).

Acts 24:10 | Acts 26:1 | ◆ Herod Antipas | ◆ Gentiles | ◆ Felix (governor) | ◆ Festus (governor) | ◆ Herod Agrippa II

Ezekiel

VIDEO Promised God's Spirit within His people and saw breath enter dry bones.

BACKGROUND A priest-prophet among the exiles in Babylon (Ezekiel 1:1-3).

Ezekiel 36:26-27 | ◆ Ezekiel (prophet)

Stephen

VIDEO Answered his accusers by recounting God's word.

BACKGROUND He was 'full of the Holy Spirit' as he died (Acts 7:55).

Acts 7:55-60 | ◆ Holy Spirit | ◆ Stephen (martyr)

Paul and Silas

VIDEO Spoke the word of the Lord to the Philippian jailer.

BACKGROUND They had been beaten with rods and jailed (Acts 16:22-24).

Acts 16:22-34 | ◆ Paul | ◆ Silas | ◆ Philippi

07 · BACKGROUND

Synagogues, kings and governors

Gold pins are background: places where Jesus' followers later faced the trials 10:17-18 describes; the pin outlined in the video's color is one the video names.



● Named in the video ● Background ▬ Paul taken from Jerusalem to the governor at Caesarea (Acts 23:23-33): route is schematic

Positions of cities from their known sites; regions and the route are approximate and schematic. Coastline, Dead Sea and most rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Sea of Galilee outline and the Yarmuk River: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Capernaum BACKGROUND

Tiberias BACKGROUND

A synagogue town: 'flog you in their synagogues' (10:17).

◆ Factbook: Capernaum ◆ Factbook: Synagogue

Herod Antipas's capital: a 'king' of the kind 10:18 describes.

◆ Factbook: Tiberias ◆ Factbook: Herod Antipas

Jerusalem VIDEO

Seat of the Sanhedrin, where the apostles were beaten (Acts 5:40), and Stephen was stoned.

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem ◆ Factbook: Sanhedrin

Caesarea Maritima BACKGROUND

The Roman governors' seat, where Paul testified before Felix, Festus and Agrippa (Acts 24-26).

◆ Factbook: Caesarea Maritima

08

Key terms

Ruach

VIDEO

Hebrew for breath, wind or spirit; the Spirit of God (Genesis 1:2; Ezekiel 36:27; 37:9, 14).

◆ Factbook: Holy Spirit

Spirit of your Father

VIDEO

Matthew's phrase in 10:20 for the Holy Spirit; Mark 13:11 says 'the Holy Spirit.'

◆ Factbook: Holy Spirit

Synagogue flogging

VIDEO

A judicial beating given to members by synagogue courts; Deuteronomy 25:3 limits it to forty lashes.

◆ Factbook: Synagogue ◆ Factbook: Flogging

Beelzebul

VIDEO

A name for the ruler of the demons (12:24); the leaders used it to slander Jesus.

◆ Factbook: Satan ◆ Factbook: Beelzebul

Housetops

VIDEO

Flat roofs where people talked and announcements were made: 'proclaim upon the housetops' means say it publicly.

Hell (Gehenna)

BACKGROUND

The place of final judgment (10:28); named for the Valley of Hinnom.

◆ Factbook: Gehenna

Assarion

BACKGROUND

A small Roman copper coin, a sixteenth of a denarius; the KJV 'farthing.'

◆ Factbook: Sparrow

Remez

VIDEO

A 'hint' that recalls a larger Old Testament passage. The captions hear it as 'Rome.'

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

λύκος

lykos `G3074`

Wolf.

Greek · Matt 10:16

◆ Factbook: Wolf

φρόνιμος

phronimos `G5429`

Shrewd, prudent, sensible.

Greek · Matt 10:16

ἀκέραιος

akeraios `G185`

Innocent, pure, 'unmixed.'

Greek · Matt 10:16

μαστιγόω

mastigoō `G3146`

To flog, scourge.

Greek · Matt 10:17

◆ Factbook: Flogging

μεριμνάω

merimnaō `G3309`

To be anxious, worry (as in 6:25-34).

Greek · Matt 10:19

◆ Factbook: Anxiety

πνεῦμα

pneuma `G4151`

Spirit, breath, wind. Look up: BDAG, πνεῦμα.

Greek · Matt 10:20

◆ Factbook: Holy Spirit

ὑπομένω

hypomenō `G5278`

To endure, remain under.

Greek · Matt 10:22

δῶμα

dōma `G1430`

Housetop, roof.

Greek · Matt 10:27

γέεννα

geenna `G1067`

Gehenna, hell.

Greek · Matt 10:28

◆ Factbook: Gehenna

στρουθίον

strouthion `G4765`

Sparrow, a small bird.

Greek · Matt 10:29, 31

◆ Factbook: Sparrow

ὁμολογέω

homologeō `G3670`

ἀρνέομαι

arneomai `G720`

To deny, disown.

To confess, acknowledge, declare openly. Look up: BDAG, ὁμολογέω.

Greek · Matt 10:32

Greek · Matt 10:33

רוּחַ

ruach `H7307`

Breath, wind, spirit; the Spirit of God. Look up: BDB or HALOT, רוּחַ.

Hebrew · Gen 1:2; Ezek 36:27; 37:9

◆ Factbook: Holy Spirit

זְאֵב

zeev `H2061`

Wolf.

Hebrew · Zeph 3:3

◆ Factbook: Wolf

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Synagogue discipline

Synagogues served as local courts as well as places of prayer. Deuteronomy 25:2-3 allowed up to forty lashes; the custom of 'forty less one' kept the limit from being broken (2 Corinthians 11:24).

Governors and kings

Judea was ruled by Roman governors from Caesarea (Pilate, later Felix and Festus), while Herod's family ruled as kings or tetrarchs (Antipas in Galilee; Agrippa I and II). Acts shows apostles before each.

Sparrows in the market

Sparrows were among the cheapest food sold in markets. Jesus' point: if God tracks even these, He knows every hair on His disciples' heads.

Ruach in the Old Testament

The same Hebrew word covers breath, wind and spirit. The Spirit gives life (Genesis 2:7 uses another word, neshamah, for breath; Ezekiel 37 uses ruach) and empowers prophets to speak God's word (Numbers 11:25; 2 Samuel 23:2).

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> *He knows that fierceness is not quenched by fierceness, but by gentleness.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 33, on 10:16. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *but here, It is the Spirit of your Father that speaks in you, advancing them unto the dignity of the prophets.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 33, on 10:20. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *"Thus, lest they should think, when killed and butchered, that as men forsaken they suffered this, He introduces again the argument of God's providence*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 34, on 10:29. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

When does the Son of Man come (10:23)?

The video: in judgment on Jerusalem and the temple in AD 70. Others: the resurrection, Pentecost, or the final return, with the mission to Israel unfinished until then. Chrysostom took it of the troubles before the cross: Jesus would rejoin them before they had gone round Palestine. It remains one of Matthew's hardest verses.

Does the Spirit give new words?

The video: the Spirit brings to mind God's word that disciples already know (John 14:26). Chrysostom: it raises them 'unto the dignity of the prophets.' Both agree the help is real and comes 'in that hour.'

One speech or gathered sayings?

Some scholars think Matthew gathered Jesus' sayings by theme, since Mark and Luke place similar words in His last week (Mark 13:9-13; Luke 21:12-19). Others think Jesus repeated such warnings. Either way, 10:17-23 looks beyond the first mission.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- In Zephaniah 3:3-4 the judges are the 'wolves at evening'; the princes are lions, the prophets 'reckless, treacherous men,' and the priests profane the sanctuary. The video groups them all as wolves.
- The link between Matthew 7:15 and Zephaniah 3 is the video's reading; Jesus does not cite Zephaniah there.
- The synagogue-flogging point is attributed to D. A. Carson; the wording could not be checked here, so read his commentary before quoting it.
- Matthew's Spirit verses are not all about spreading the kingdom: several are about Jesus' conception and baptism (1:18, 20; 3:16).
- The closing preview says John the Baptist's disciples come next; the next video is Matthew 10:34-42 ('not peace, but a sword'). John's question comes in 11:2-6. The captions also hear 'remez' as 'Rome.'

From Zephaniah to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 10:16-33 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

c. 630 BC DEBATED
Zephaniah: judges like wolves at evening
Zephaniah 3:3-4 *Echo: 10:16*

c. 585 BC
Ezekiel: My Spirit within you; breath into dry bones
Ezekiel 36:26-27 *Echo: 10:20*

c. AD 29 DEBATED
Jesus sends the Twelve as sheep among wolves
Matthew 10:16-33 *This episode*

c. AD 30 DEBATED
Pentecost: the Spirit poured out; Peter preaches
Acts 2:14-36

c. AD 34 DEBATED
Stephen's speech and death
Acts 7:2-60

c. AD 50 DEBATED
Paul and Silas and the Philippian jailer
Acts 16:25-34

AD 70
Jerusalem and the temple destroyed
Matthew 24:1-2

c. AD 390
Chrysostom: 'fierceness is not quenched by fierceness'
Matthew 10:16

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Mark 13:9-13
'It is not you who speak, but it is the Holy Spirit'
ADDED

Luke 12:11-12
The Holy Spirit will teach you in that hour
ADDED

Luke 21:12-15
'I will give you a mouth and wisdom'
ADDED

Acts 4:8-13
Peter, filled with the Holy Spirit, before the rulers
ADDED

Isaiah 8:12-13
Do not fear what they fear; fear Yahweh
ADDED

Micah 7:6
A man's enemies are of his own household (10:21, 36)
ADDED

2 Timothy 2:12
If we deny Him, He also will deny us
ADDED

1 Peter 3:14-15
Do not fear; be ready to make a defense
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1. When have you felt like a sheep among wolves? What would 'shrewd as serpents and innocent as doves' have looked like?
2. How does hearing 'Spirit' as ruach, through Ezekiel 36-37, change how you read 10:20?
3. Which do you find harder: not fearing people, or confessing Jesus before them?
4. What does the image of sparrows and numbered hairs say about how God sees you?
5. Practice the teacher's method: who is the audience, why is Jesus speaking this way, and what did they need to know?
6. What part of God's word could you get to know better this week, so you are ready when asked?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The teacher talks through how he finds a lesson. The original audience is the disciples listening to their rabbi. Why is Jesus speaking this way? He is preparing them to go out, and for a time when He will not be physically present. In verse 19 He says 'do not worry,' so they either struggle with anxiety now or will when these things happen. Put

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

choose one passage you would want to have ready if someone asked about your faith (for example Psalm 2, Isaiah 53 or Ezekiel 36:26-27). Read it daily this week and say it aloud once from memory by Sunday.

that together with the ruach of God from Ezekiel 36 and 37, who causes God's people to walk in His statutes and brings them back to what the Lord has said, and with John 14:26, where the Holy Spirit brings to remembrance all that Jesus said. The lesson: when the disciples of Jesus know God's word, they'll never fear to know what to say. This is not a free pass to skip reading Scripture; it depends on how well we know God's word. The same is true today: the answer to anxiety about being caught off guard by skeptics is to know God's word even more.

> *"When the disciples of Jesus know God's word, they'll never fear to know what to say.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

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